

Manually Downloading and Installing Packages in R

Asked 10 years, 3 months ago Modified 4 months ago Viewed 113k times  Part of [R Language Collective](#)



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I am currently trying to run some R code on a computing cluster but cannot run the `install.packages` function due to some weird firewall settings on my cluster. Since I am only using a few packages in my R code, I was hoping to avoid using the `install.packages` function by downloading and installing the packages manually.

Note: I am aware that there is a way to avoid this issue by using an HTTP proxy as described in the R FAQ. Unfortunately the people in charge of my cluster are not being helpful in setting this up so I'm forced to consider this alternative approach.

Ideally, I would like to download the packages files from CRAN to my computer, then upload these files to the cluster and install them using the appropriate commands in R. In addition, I would also like to make sure that the packages are installed to a location of my choice since I do not have the permission to "write" in the default R directory (I believe that I can do this within R by using the `.libPaths` function)

Lastly, the computers that I am working with on the cluster are Unix x86_64.

r

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asked Feb 11, 2013 at 5:59



[Berk U.](#)

6,928 6 44 69

- 1 It's certainly possible to do this, and the `install.packages` function will accept a NULL repository argument. – [IRTFM](#) Feb 11, 2013 at 6:04

Awesome! I didn't realize this at all. Just to confirm the following snippet should work, correct?
`install.packages(pkgs = MyListofTARGZFiles, repos = NULL, lib = MyLibraryDirectory)`
– [Berk U.](#) Feb 11, 2013 at 6:09

Not sure exactly that formalism would work, assuming it is really a list. The first argument needs to be a character vector. – [IRTFM](#) Feb 11, 2013 at 6:13

4 Answers

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You can install the package manually using the following command

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```
install.packages('package.zip', lib='destination_directory', repos = NULL)
```



See the help of `?install.packages`, for further description



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answered Feb 11, 2013 at 6:09



iTech

18.2k 4 57 80



Thanks! Just to make sure: since I'm working on UNIX computers, shouldn't the packages be in tar.gz format? – [Berk U.](#) Feb 11, 2013 at 6:10

1 If you have the package source `.tar.gz` it should work as well – [iTech](#) Feb 11, 2013 at 6:13

In my case, this throws an error telling a NAMESPACE file is required. >
`install.packages('/Users/arun/Desktop/DiagnosisMed_0.2.3.tar.gz', lib=~'/Library/R/3.3/library/', repos = NULL) * installing *source* package 'DiagnosisMed' ... ERROR: a 'NAMESPACE' file is required * removing '/Users/arun/Library/R/3.3/library/DiagnosisMed' Warning in install.packages : installation of package '/Users/arun/Desktop/DiagnosisMed_0.2.3.tar.gz' had non-zero exit status` – [arun](#) Jul 20, 2016 at 21:07

how do you download packages as zip files ? – [user3079364](#) Oct 19, 2018 at 20:01



2

I also went through the same problem while installing the caret package. There are many dependencies of the caret package. So, I did the following:



`install.packages('caret')` : This gives all packages in zip format the location of download is shown in the error message. Unzip all packages from download source to a location for example in `C:/PublicData/RawR Packages`, then run following command.



```
foldername <- 'C:/PublicData/RawR Packages'
install.packages(paste(foldername, 'caret', sep = '/'),
                 repos = NULL, type = "source")
library(caret, lib.loc = foldername)
```

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edited Jan 21 at 1:42



bathyscapher

1,369 1 10 18

answered Aug 12, 2018 at 12:38



Thunder

10.3k 25 84 113

Your solution is very useful, because it is not necessary to know the destination directory of the package! It is found automatically. – [EmaK](#) Jan 28 at 20:08



this the better way, if we want to download and install locally :

1

```
download.packages('lib_name',destdir='dest_path')
```



for example :



```
download.packages('RJDBC',destdir='d:/rlibs')
```

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answered Apr 21, 2018 at 9:58



[adramazany](#)

605 8 14

1 Am I missing something, or does this not pull down dependencies? – [Foon](#) Apr 13, 2020 at 18:17



```
install.packages("libname",lib = "file:///F:/test")
```

0

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edited Dec 28, 2019 at 21:25

answered Apr 20, 2017 at 19:36

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[Dharman](#) ♦

30.3k 22 84 132



[Angel](#)

61 1 1 12



1 I added it because myself had problems with the format of library. Thought maybe it helps someone else! – [Angel](#) Apr 21, 2017 at 6:23



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